

Nick Mourtopalas

VISUAL & DATA JOURNALIST

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 LinkedIn 

SUMMARY

Visual and data journalist explaining public affairs through reporting, analysis, cartography and code. Combines an economics background with experience producing breaking-news explainers, live trackers and long-form publications. Builds editorial tools for sustained coverage as stories develop.

SKILLS

Data analysis & development

JavaScript, D3.js, React, HTML, CSS, Python, R, Excel, Google Apps Script

Visualization & mapping tools

Datawrapper, Flourish, RAWGraphs, Observable, Mapbox, QGIS, Mapshaper, Google Earth Pro, Pictometry, ai2html

Design & production

Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign, After Effects, Figma, Blender

Platforms & workflows

GitHub, APIs, Photo Mechanic, newsroom CMS tools, publication QA

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts, Economics

University of Maryland, College Park
2013 – 2017

CERTIFICATIONS

Data Analytics and Visualization

George Washington University 

Data Analytics

Google 

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

North American Cartographic Information Society

Society for News Design

National Press Club

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Graphic Design & Web Publishing Manager

2026 – Present

Brookings Metro, Washington, D.C.

- Translate economic and public policy research into visual explanations, producing or supporting 30+ data visualizations across static and interactive formats.
- Shape long-form research into clear, navigable publications, organizing text, charts and supporting material in policy reports spanning 60–80 pages.
- Manage the full digital publishing process, preparing articles, reports and newsletters, integrating visual assets and embedded media, and checking responsive presentation and page quality before release.
- Expanded capacity for custom visual storytelling by introducing a responsive graphics workflow, with reusable templates and documentation for colleagues.

Graphics Reporter

2022 – 2026

The Washington Post, Washington, D.C.

- Reported legislative developments through live data and visual explanations, analyzing vote margins and partisan divisions in more than 30 congressional trackers and investigations, including updates from the House chamber.
- Mapped how geography shapes political power, using Maryland and Texas redistricting and eight 2024 presidential-election scenarios to explain the consequences of district boundaries and battleground outcomes.
- Analyzed public records to explain demographic change and representation, using Census Bureau and Federal Judicial Center data for stories on immigration-driven population growth and the diversity of judicial appointments.
- Built structured datasets to monitor public institutions over time, including trackers of Supreme Court decisions and judicial confirmations.
- Developed reusable publishing systems for recurring coverage, combining frameworks and automation to update graphics across newsroom desks.

News Aide

2017 – 2022

The Washington Post, Washington, D.C.

- Collaborated across graphics, photography and print to support coverage of major events, including elections, the pandemic and periods of civil unrest.
- Managed photo workflows, captions and metadata; laid out next-day pages for the A section, Metro, Sports and Style under nightly production deadlines.

Editorial Intern

2017

The Kiplinger Letter, Washington, D.C.

- Fact-checked and copy-edited economic analysis, refining a weekly forecasting publication on fiscal and monetary policy, labor markets and inflation.
- Verified economic claims and trends against official statistics, using BLS, BEA and Federal Reserve data to substantiate reporting and forecasts.